

Electronic Communication Policy & Procedure

Version 1

	Ted's Cameras	Version: 2
Number 5	Electronic Communications Policy	Updated August 2022

Electronic Communications Policy

1. Purpose

This policy applies to the use of the Company's electronic resources at any location, whether at home, at work, at other sites, and at any time.

Ted's Cameras provides employees with internet access, email, and other electronic messaging tools to enable our team to conduct company business, to enhance productivity and assist with business communications. It is expected that these resources and facilities will normally be used only for the purposes of administration, communication and research, where this is related to meeting the accountabilities of the users' role within Ted's Cameras .

The purpose of this policy is to ensure that electronic communication tools provided by Ted's Cameras are used appropriately, and to protect Ted's Cameras from illegal activities such as defamation, fraud, breach of copyright, privacy violations and unlawful discrimination. Appropriate use of electronic communication tools will also protect the company's network from service interruptions.

2. Scope

This policy applies to everyone who uses Ted's Cameras 's electronic resources, including but not limited to all Ted's Cameras employees, contractors, consultants and temporary staff.

Desktop computers, laptop computers, tablets

Email and intranet facilities

Social Media

Desk phones and mobile phones

Printers, photocopiers, and scanners

Network servers, hubs, routers, and other network devices

All data storage devices (online and offline)

Building security systems

Point of Sale systems and merchant facilities

Any other electronic device, resource or system

3. Definitions

Manager: Manager, Store Manager, Assistant Store Manager, Relief Manager, Line Manager.

Electronic Communications: includes publishing and browsing on the internet, electronic mail, electronic bulletin boards, electronic discussion groups, file transfer, videoconferencing, SMS, streaming media, instant messaging, chat facilities and other means of electronic communication that may become available because of recent technologies.

4. Responsibility

Ted's Cameras management are responsible for the implementation and monitoring of this policy.

Employees must ensure that all devices used to access electronic communications, including but not limited to laptops, notebooks, tablets, smart-phones, and memory sticks are to the greatest extent password protected or encrypted.

5. Policy

This policy identifies the actions that Ted's Cameras considers to be acceptable. If you are unsure about acceptable usage, you should ask your manager.

Key Points

Personal use of electronic resources is permitted if it complies with guidelines for personal use set out in this policy.

There is no expectation of privacy when using Ted's Cameras electronic resources.

You must take due care of all Ted's Cameras equipment and take all necessary steps to protect it from loss, theft or damage.

You must not make alterations to Ted's Cameras equipment (e.g., Adding or removing software). Refer to IT Support for assistance.

You must comply with all relevant Ted's Cameras policies when using the company electronic resources, including but not limited to Acceptable Workplace Behaviour Policy and others prohibiting harassment, discrimination, offensive conduct, or inappropriate behaviour.

Use of the Ted's Cameras electronic resources must be lawful and in accordance with all relevant federal and state legislation. Such legislation shall include but not be limited to legislation covering privacy, copyright, freedom of information, equal employment opportunity, intellectual property and occupational health and safety.

Ted's Cameras holds copyright over all documents, data and any other items created by you in the course of your employment with Ted's Cameras .

Ted's Cameras owns all data stored on company electronic resources

Ted's Cameras reserves the right to monitor and examine usage of internet, telephone, voice mail and email messages and any other information stored electronically. This monitoring and examination helps to ensure compliance with internal policies, supports the performance of internal investigations, and assists with the management of the company's electronic resources.

Appropriate Use

Our electronic communications network is primarily used as a business tool for the conduct of Ted's Cameras business. Users of the electronic communications network must comply with The Company's Information Technology (IT) User Guidelines and with all related laws including those relating to privacy, copyright, freedom of information, telecommunications interception, records, criminal activity, defamation, and spam.

Inappropriate and Illegal Usage

Defamatory material

Copyright material without appropriate authorisation

Could be deemed to be discriminatory, offensive, obscene, or indecent

Could be deemed likely to harass, intimidate, harm or distress

Online gaming

Illegal material of any kind

Streaming audio and video (not related to job role)

Distribute information which disparages Ted's Cameras , its directors, officers, clients/customers or any employee/s or organise activity which seeks to interrupt or limit any of its operations.

For personal financial gain or loss. This includes but is not limited to gambling, pyramid selling and multi-level marketing.

To conduct outside business ventures or usurp Ted's Cameras business opportunities in violation of Acceptable Workplace Behaviour Policy and Code of Conduct.

To solicit or promote religious causes, political causes, or external organisations.

To reveal or publish Ted's Cameras 's proprietary or confidential information without authorisation.

To violate or attempt to violate any law.

Company electronic resources must not be used to create, store, access or transmit any sexual material, including but not limited to:

Any text containing sexual references, e.g sexual jokes, lurid SMS messages

Sexually explicit images: e.g. Pornography, nudity, obscene material

Unlawful material that breaches censorship laws

Company electronic resources must not be used to gain or attempt to gain unauthorised access to:

Any other person's computer, email, voicemail accounts, data storage or other electronic resources

Computers or computer networks belonging to Ted's Cameras

Building and facilities

Breaching Privacy laws or confidential information.

In addition, users of the tool may not print, document on any system or display any harassing, threatening, sexually explicit images, obscene or offensive material which is likely to offend others with access to viewing that material. The display or storage of any kind of sexually explicit image on any system is a violation of our anti-harassment policy. In addition, sexually explicit or offensive material must not be archived, edited, or recorded using our network or computing resources.

If connected accidentally to a site that contains sexually explicit or offensive material, you must disconnect from that site immediately.

Employees must not use the Company's network to find the password to another user's account or download, store, copy, modify or delete any software program or data unless authorised to do so.

Employees must not use the company's electronic communications services in a way which places inappropriate strains on the normal IT resource capacity.

Care of Company Property

You must take due care of all Ted's Cameras equipment and take all necessary steps to ensure that equipment is not lost, stolen or damaged.

Any modifications to equipment must be authorised and executed by IT Support. You must not tamper with any electronic equipment. You must not add, change, remove, or swap any internal or external hardware. You must not add, change, or remove any software, unless instructed to by authorized personnel.

Loss, theft or damage of equipment must be reported to your manager and IT Support.

All electronic communications created by employees and transmitted over the company network will be regarded as the property of Ted's Cameras . Electronic communications may be treated as company records where they relate to business or operational matters and may be subject to disclosure under Freedom of Information legislation or because of civil or criminal litigation.

Privacy

The Company has software and systems in place that monitor and record all electronic communications, for operational, maintenance, compliance and/or security reasons (for example, tracking of messages that cause system failures because of virus transmission and monitoring for inappropriate usage and content to protect Ted's Cameras from illegal activities).

Our security systems can record each www site visit and each email message into and out of the internal networks, and we reserve the right to do so at any time. Managers will review internet activity and analyse usage patterns and may choose to distribute this data to relevant managers to ensure that our internet resources are devoted to maintaining the highest levels of productivity.

Employees should be aware that electronic messages are inherently insecure, and that confidentiality of information cannot be guaranteed. System logs may store information about senders and receivers of information via the network and that deleting an email does not mean it cannot be recovered.

We reserve the right to inspect all files stored in private areas of the network to assure compliance with the company's policy.

System Protection

Users of Ted's Cameras 's electronic communications facilities must take appropriate action to protect our network, by:

Complying with all online requests from the IT department which are designed to protect the company network.

Password protecting all desktop and mobile devices including laptop computers, smart phones, tablets and notebooks.

You should change your password regularly to prevent unauthorized access to Ted's Cameras electronic resources.

You are responsible for everything done using your username. You should not disclose your username or password to anyone except IT Support.

If you suspect that someone else knows your password, then you should change it immediately, and notify your manager and IT Support of your suspicions.

Not sharing information such as, user IDs, passwords, ID for an internet resource or passwords obtained for internet sites.

Installing and using recommended virus scan programs on any private PC which exchanges data with our network.

Not opening executable files attached to email messages.

Not distributing chain email messages.

Limiting the size of large messages and attachments before sending.

Making large documents available for download from a web server and providing a URL in an email.

Limiting distribution of files to indiscriminate mailing lists.

Limiting storage requirements by deleting unwanted emails (considering the need to store business and operational records) and/or

Logging off the computer when access is no longer required.

Employees must not write or execute programs which could infiltrate our IT services or modify or damage software. We have installed an internet firewall to assure the safety and security of our networks. Any employee who attempts to disable, defeat or circumvent any security facility is considered a serious breach of conduct.

Employees must not interfere with any wireless or radio transmission that is part of our wireless network and associated hardware.

Confidential & Proprietary Information

Confidential and proprietary information is available via Ted's Cameras's computer network and other electronic resources.

You may receive such information in the course of your employment with Ted's Cameras, for the purpose of enabling you to properly perform your employment duties. This information is bound by the Confidentiality Clause in your employment contract.

You must not duplicate, reproduce or distribute confidential information, except what is necessary to properly perform your employment duties. If you are required to use confidential information in a way that is not compliant with the Confidentiality Clause in your employment contract, then written authorization is required from the CEO.

Departing Employees

All documents, emails, data and other information collected or created in the course of your employment with Ted's Cameras is owned by the company. Do not delete documents, email messages, transfer data or any other information

held on Ted's Cameras electronic resources when you know that your employment is ending or will end in the near future. Your manager will determine whether this information should be deleted as part of the hand-over process.

Breach / Non-Compliance of the Policy

Non-compliance with this policy may result in action including but not limited to:

Denial of access to the Ted's Cameras electronic resources.

Disciplinary action, which may include counselling, a warning, suspension, or instant dismissal.

Criminal prosecution by relevant authority.

This policy will be regularly reviewed in consultation with employees to ensure account is taken of any company and legislative changes.

Ted's Cameras seeks co-operation from all employees in maintaining this policy.

All employees will be advised of agreed changes and arrangements for their implementation.

6. Related documents

Social Media Policy

Code of Conduct

Drug and Alcohol Policy and Procedure

Work Health & Safety Policy

Information Technology (IT) User Guidelines

Employment Contract

7. Version control

Version	Description of Changes	Date Issued	Author
1	Document created and approved	3 Dec 2015	KH
	12-month review		KH
2	Document reviewed and updated	14 Feb 2019	SD, National HR Manager
	2 year Review	14 Feb 2021	
3	Document reviewed and updated	August 2022	AMC
	Review Due	August 2024	

Further assistance

Further information, advice or assistance please contact Human Resources on phone: (03) 8779 5504 or email: hr@Ted'sCameras.com.au